



UGANDA CHRISTIAN UNIVERSITY

A Centre of Excellence in the Heart of Africa

Course Work1: for Understanding Worldviews;

Qn1. Read the book: How Now Shall We Live? C. Colson & N. Pearcey, Wheaton: Tyndale, 1999. Clash of Worlds

- a. Page 14: How is a Worldview defined?
- b. Page 17: what does it mean by “real culture war” and what is its impact on our community to day.
- c. Page 34: what does it mean to disciple the mind?

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According to Charles Colson worldview is defined as the sum total of our beliefs about the world, or the “big picture” that guides our daily decisions and actions. In other words, it is the way we see and understand reality which shapes how we live. Every person develops a worldview from culture, religion, education, experiences and social interactions. For example, if someone believes in God, they may live from people who believe life to be a result of choice. They also determine how individuals seek happiness and satisfaction in life. The statement “everything we do, how and why we do it will give us endless pleasure and complete satisfaction in the now and hereafter” reflects the idea that human actions and intentions are deeply connected to fulfillment and purpose.

Different world views explain satisfaction and happiness in different ways. **Materialistic world views** emphasize wealth, success, pleasure and personal achievement as the main source of fulfillment. Therefore people can achieve satisfaction through career success, luxurious life styles and recognition in society.

Religious and spiritual world views provide a different understanding of satisfaction. For instance Christianity and Islam teach that true fulfillment comes from living according to moral principles, serving God and humanity. Actions done with honesty, compassion, love and justice bring inner peace in the present life and life after.

Ethics refer to moral principles and values that guide human behaviour. Every profession has ethical standards that help maintain trust, fairness and responsibility. For example doctors are expected to protect life and treat patients equally.

According to page 17 of Charles Colson's book, **real culture war** is not merely about issues such as abortion, homosexuality or education, but is rather a conflict between Christian world views and competing secular worldviews. It is therefore noteworthy that real culture wars have had some several impacts on society today as discussed below.

Moral decline in society:

When society abandons biblical truth, moral values begin to weaken. Colson describes a culture where immorality is tolerated, violence increases, and people become indifferent to right and wrong, which leads to a breakdown of civil and community life.

Confusion about truth:

People begin to believe that truth is relative and that everyone can decide

what is right or wrong for themselves, which creates confusion in moral and social decision-making.

Weakening of Christian influence:

Christians are often labelled intolerant or bigoted when they defend biblical values, and as a result many believers withdraw from public life and stop influencing society positively.

Breakdown of families and communities:

The culture war affects family structures and community relationships. Individual freedom without moral responsibility can lead to social disorder and loss of community bonds.

Difficulty in passing values to the next generation:

Without a strong worldview, parents and teachers struggle to answer challenges that young people face; hence children may become vulnerable to conflicting ideas and beliefs.

According to page 34 of Charles Colson's book, discipling the mind means developing a distinctly Christian way of thinking and learning to love God with our minds as well as our hearts. A disciplined mind is a mind trained to think carefully and systematically within a particular field of knowledge or discipline.

- Disciplining the mind involves taking “**every thought captive**” to Christ:
- Renewing the mind according to God's truth.
- Understanding God's principles for every area of life, including society, government, education, science, and the arts.
- Rejecting the false separation between faith and reason and cultivating a Christian worldview.
- It encourages independent thinking where a person learns to evaluate information rather than blindly accepting opinions

In conclusion, worldviews play an important role in shaping human behaviour, values, and understanding of satisfaction. The statement, “what we do, how we do it, and why we do it gives us endless pleasure,” reflects the importance of purpose and intention in life.